Norman Myers



Myers was born in 1934 and grew up in the north of England. He studied at the University of Oxford before moving to Kenya, where he worked as a government administrator and teacher. During the 1970s, Myers studied at the University of California, Berkeley, where his interest in the environment grew. He raised concerns about deforestation for cattle ranching, describing it as the "hamburger connection."

Myers raised the concept of biodiversity hotspots in the article "Threatened Biotas: 'Hotspots' in Tropical Forests," published in *The Environmentalist* in 1988. In his first book, *Ultimate Security: The Environmental Basis of Political Stability*, he argued that environmental problems lead to social and political crises. In 2007, *Time* magazine hailed Myers as a Hero of the Environment.

Key works

1988 "Threatened Biotas: Hotspots in Tropical Forests"

1993 *Ultimate Security: The Environmental Basis of Political Stability*

See also: Human activity and biodiversity • The ecosystem • Deforestation • Halting biodiversity loss